

BLACK.

Then, the roar of crowd fades in, and --

INT. LITTLE CAESAR'S ARENA - WWE PAY PER VIEW

Lights shine on thousands of fans cheering on as TWO MEN beat the crap out of each other half naked in a ring in the middle of the arena.

MIKE ASH (O.C.)

If you're just joining us now, we are LIVE! In a sold out arena as everyone's favorite champion, Max Freedom, defends his title against the man who is willing to do whatever it takes to ruin his life, Renegade.

MAX FREEDOM (Uncle Sam with muscles) is passed out on the canvas while RENEGADE (every bully you've ever known), exhausted, tries to move towards his opponent.

MIKE ASH (O.C.) (CONT'D)

Both men are down! This is still anyone's match!

Renegade manages to get to his knees and pulls Max up with him.

BOOM! Renegade throws a punch. POW! Max answers. They trade blows as the crowd "oohs" and "ahhs" with every hit.

Max jumps up for an acrobatic move, but when he lands --

POP!

MAX

OW! SHIT! I think I just broke my knee!

REFEREE

Shut up and wrestle, kid.

Renegade grabs Max by the injured leg, unaware, and drags him to the center of the ring. Max tries to wave Renegade off, but he ignores him in true villain fashion.

Renegade specifically targets Max's bad knee for good show, and Max wails in pain after every hit.

MAX
FUCK! DICK! SHIT! STOP I'M REALLY
INJURED!

RENEGADE
(finally getting it)
Oh nooooooooo, I'm so sorry. Are you
okay?

The referee overhears this and hurriedly reports the injury
to his headset.

In the blink of an eye, the referee gets a response and moves
closer to instruct Renegade.

REFEREE
New finish. Pin him.

Renegade's eyes go wide and they meet Max's.

Max knows his expression and tries to crawl out of the ring
to escape his fate, but Renegade catches him by the bad leg
and drags him again. Max's pain is audible once more.

Renegade stands Max up, he puts him on his shoulder, and

RENEGADE
(in Max's ear)
I'm sorry, but I have to do this.

SLAM! Max goes down.

Renegade pins Max, and the referee slides into the count:

1, 2, 3. DING! DING! DING!

Renegade wins.

New Champ.

The sound of the boos begins to fade out as we --

ZOOM OUT:

INT. WWE HEADQUARTERS - LOBBY - THE NEXT DAY

The results of the match play out on a TV as FREDDIE URICH
(20s, thinks he knows better) uses the remote to mute it.

FREDDIE
Wow, that's the fakest thing I've
ever seen in my life.

From the corner of the room, a door is opened by a secretary in work pants and a polo donning the famous W Logo of the wrestling brand.

SECRETARY

Freddie Urich, interviewing for
staff writer?

FREDDIE

That's me!

SECRETARY

Right this way.

Titles: **THE SQUARED CIRCLE**

ACT ONE

INT. WWE HEADQUARTERS - SHEILA'S OFFICE - MOMENTS LATER

The secretary leads Freddie into an office whose door reads :
"Sheila Trace - Head Writer".

Freddie has a seat across an empty desk.

FREDDIE

Thanks. Am I supposed to-

The secretary leaves without a word.

FREDDIE (CONT'D)

O-kay...

Freddie takes the time to look around the room.

His eyes land on an authentic championship belt.

Before touching it, he looks around - coast is clear. He
tries to pick it up, but immediately misjudges the weight and
falls to the floor.

SHEILA (O.C.)

Freddie Urich?

FREDDIE

I'm sorry!

SHEILA TRACE (47) stands above Freddie glaring down at him,
clipboard in hand.

SHEILA

Are you on the floor?

FREDDIE

Me? No, this belt fell, I was just
going to pick it up, but yeah.

SHEILA

Uh-huh. Nice to meet you. Are you
ready to start?

Freddie jumps up.

FREDDIE

The interview?

SHEILA

Oh, you want to be interviewed?
Sure, we can do that right now. Can
you tell me about some of your
experience? Your manager, Jack, I
think--

FREDDIE

(Rushing past it)
--That's the one! Good friend of
mine, Jack.

SHEILA

Yeah, he spoke about some
commercial work you've done.
(looks down at notes)
Baby wipes, dog food --

FREDDIE

Talking dog! Actually pretty funny.

SHEILA

-- Anti-Bullying PSA and Bullying
PSA? I thought that was weird.

FREDDIE

That must be some mistake.

SHEILA

He also told me you worked on a
movie franchise?

FREDDIE

Yes, of course! The franchise!
Yeah, I worked on three films, all
sequels, but all distinct. Really
stretched my creative muscles.

SHEILA

Yeah, he mentioned it was a passion
project, still unproduced.

FREDDIE

I'm not sure how he'd know that,
we're not that close.

SHEILA

Anyway, we're really not looking
for any of this.

FREDDIE

Well, I can have a passion for
other things and I'm a really quick
learner.

SHEILA

Alright, what do you think we could improve with WWE?

FREDDIE

Where do I start? You guys should hire better actors. Also the costumes look stupid, and that belt does not feel real at all. I would tell you to hire a better writer, but --

He does a bow.

SHEILA

I'm the head writer.

FREDDIE

(grimacing)

Love the work, huge fan.

SHEILA

You've got a lot to learn. Follow me. Also, wear this.

She slaps a sticky tag on him that reads: NOT A WRESTLER.

Freddie looks confused, but follows her lead anyway.

INT. WWE HEADQUARTERS - CONTROL ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

The pair walk into what looks like the cockpit of an airplane. Screens, buttons, and wires - lots of wires - cover every inch of this room except for a wall of windows that look down into the arena.

In the arena, a crew of WORKERS can be seen preparing the ring in the middle, the screens around the arena, and the stage where wrestlers walk down from.

A couple of Crew Members sit inside the control room at different monitors, tinkering or editing footage, without acknowledging their presence.

SHEILA

This is the show of it. Everything you see on TV and down there,
(points out the windows)
Is managed up here.

FREDDIE

Wow, this is like a real movie studio.

SHEILA
Yup, we've got pyro too.

FREDDIE
Pyro?

SHEILA
Sally.

SALLY turns her head, and Sheila gives her a nod. She presses one button and --

BOOM!

Two walls of fire ERUPT near the stage inside of the arena. Freddie jumps back a little.

SHEILA (CONT'D)
Sally's the best and Fireworks are some of the best parts of the show.

FREDDIE
Can I try pressing one --

SHEILA
Absolutely not, Sally will set you on fire if you try.

Freddie gives half a laugh then spots Sally's death stare, and drops the smile.

SHEILA (CONT'D)
I need you to see this.

Sheila motions Freddie towards a monitor, and a match comes alive.

SHEILA (CONT'D)
This is what happened last night at our Pay-Per View.

Freddie watches the events of the teaser unfold.

FREDDIE
Yeah I saw this match in the lobby. I don't get why you made that guy look hurt when it was so obviously fake.

SHEILA
I'm glad you think so, because that was our star and he got injured for real. Now we have a new champion that everyone hates.

FREDDIE
Why is that bad?

SHEILA
Fans aren't happy, the show doesn't
run and we lose our jobs.

FREDDIE
Damn. So, what are you going to do?

SHEILA
That's where you come in. Let's see
what the degree can do. I'll give
you one shot today to prove
yourself, what do you say?

FREDDIE
I --

Brrring!

Freddie looks down at his phone.

FREDDIE (CONT'D)
Hold on, that's my manager.
(into the phone)
Jack, my man, how's it going? Any
more offers?

The volume on the phone is just loud enough for Sheila to
hear.

MOM (O.S.)
Where have you been, sweetheart?
I've been worried sick.

Sheila glares judgingly.

SHEILA
(mouthing sarcastically)
Your manager?

Freddie gives a nervous smile.

FREDDIE
Sorry, Mom, I've just been working
really hard.

MOM
OH! Did someone say they'd shoot
your movie?!

FREDDIE
Not exactly --

MOM

Frederick! It's time you come home!
We can get you working at Dad's
shop. Why don't we just fly you
home?!

Freddie begins to sweat under the pressure. He looks to
Sheila and makes a split decision.

FREDDIE

Mom, I've actually got a new job,
but I've got to go now, we'll talk
later. Bye.

Freddie hangs up and keeps his head down as he slowly puts
his phone away.

SHEILA

So... Jack wouldn't happen to be
your mom?

FREDDIE

Nope. No.

SHEILA

That's what I thought. Ready to get
started?

FREDDIE

Ready as I'll ever be.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

INT. WWE HEADQUARTERS - WRITERS ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Sheila leads Freddie to a conference table with many empty chairs.

SHEILA
This is the writer's room.

FREDDIE
And the writers?

SHEILA
All quit. So, this kingdom is ours.

FREDDIE
Does this kingdom have a bathroom?

SHEILA
Out the door, first door to the left. Don't be long though, we have a show tonight we have to start planning.

FREDDIE
(sarcastically)
I'll pee like my life's on the line.

SHEILA
It is.

Freddie leaves with a pit in his stomach.

INT. WWE HEADQUARTERS - BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Freddie walks into a bathroom with one stall, and two urinals, one of each is occupied with a man in wrestling gear.

Freddie begins to use the other one, but immediately is stunned when he recognizes Max Freedom peeing next to him.

FREDDIE
Hold on, is Max Freedom peeing next to me? Dude, huge fan. Had no idea you peed. You rock.

MAX
Don't mention it.